HiveMind × Ravensbourne – Practical Student Flow

This checklist gives you a concrete, step-by-step workflow for the 4-week UX Product Discovery Sprint.

Contacts & Communication

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Your Mission: Product Discovery Squad

We need to know if our proposed features truly solve Christoph's pain points. Your team will act as a **Product Discovery Squad**—taking our core features (Onboarding, Knowledge Hub, AI Assistant), designing high-fidelity prototypes, and conducting rapid market research to test their usefulness and usability.

Christoph's Pain Points (by focus area)

Focus Area	Key Pain Points
"Christoph" Dashboard	Cognitive load, scattered information across tools, no unified view, difficult navigation
Smart Onboarding	First-time user experience feels impersonal, unclear next steps, no guided path
Trustworthy AI Assistant	Users don't trust AI suggestions, unclear where answers come from, no transparency in reasoning

Your job is to validate whether the solutions your group designs actually address these pain points through real research with your **target audience** (professionals in the workplace—not students).

Resources & Links

- **GitHub:** Create your own group repository and invite us (andrei@hivemindacademy.com, madalina@hivemindacademy.com).
- **Figma design file:** `Hivemind Design.fig` (provided in the resources folder)

- **HiveMind colour palette:** `HiveMind Academy – Colour Palette.jam` (provided in the resources folder)
- **Carbon Design System:** https://carbondesignsystem.com
- **Carbon React Storybook:** https://react.carbondesignsystem.com

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Repository & folder structure

Set up your group GitHub repo so that your evidence pack is easy to follow. Suggested structure:

```
your-repo/
├── README.md                 # Project summary, group members, roles, links to Figma
├── weekly-log.md             # What was done each week, by whom, time spent
├── docs/
│   ├── research-plan.md      # Who you interview, when, which questions
│   ├── hypotheses.md         # 3–5 testable hypotheses
│   ├── success-metrics.md    # How you'll measure success
│   └── decisions.md          # Scope changes, key decisions
├── research/
│   └── (raw interview notes, consent, synthesis)
├── design/
│   └── (journey maps, IA diagrams, wireframes, hi-fi exports – PNG/PDF)
├── testing/
│   ├── tasks.md              # 2–3 critical user tasks
│   └── (test script, participant notes, metrics)
├── delivery/
│   ├── validation-report.md  # Findings and recommendations
│   └── (presentation deck)
└── tech/                     # Optional – AI Assistant stretch only
    ├── README.md             # How to run the app and Storybook
    ├── src/
    │   └── (React/Carbon components, app code)
    └── (config, Storybook, etc.)
```

Keep filenames clear so someone external can trace your process from start to finish.

Weekly Cross-Group Check-ins

Alongside your group work, short weekly **Skill Check-ins** (20–30 minutes) help everyone stay on track across all 6 groups. Pick the one that matches your main role:

1. **Research & Testing Check-in** — running interviews/usability tests, writing questions, note-taking, synthesising insights.

2. **Design & Structure Check-in** — navigation, consistent page structure, where key info should live, avoiding "messy" navigation.
3. **Reporting & Evidence Check-in** — keeping a strong evidence pack, decision logs, version naming, report structure, screenshots.

How it runs: share 1 thing you've done + 1 challenge you're stuck on. Leave with a clear next step or a reusable template.

Before Week 1: Set up your workspace

1. **Read the brief and confirm your focus area**
    - Read the HiveMind × Ravensbourne brief.
    - Confirm if your group is working on: **"Christoph" Dashboard**, **Smart Onboarding**, or **Trustworthy AI Assistant**.
    - Review Christoph's pain points for your area (see table above).
2. **Confirm roles in your group**
    - Agree who is: Project Lead, UX Research & Validation Lead, UX/IA Designer, UI/Prototype Designer, and any optional CS roles.
    - Make sure everyone also has a small secondary "hat" (e.g., Documentation/QA).
3. **Create shared tools**
    - Create a **GitHub repo** for your group.
    - Create a **Figma file** with pages: `Research`, `IA & Flows`, `Wireframes`, `UI`, `Prototype`.

Week 1: Discovery & Hypotheses

1. **Understand Christoph and the problem space**
    - As a group, review the Christoph persona and pain points for your focus area.
    - UX/IA Designer sketches an initial **current journey** for your focus area on the Figma **Research** page.
2. **Plan your interviews / "pre-totype" research**
    - UX Research Lead drafts 6–8 neutral interview questions about onboarding, finding information, and workplace support.
    - Your **target audience is professionals in the workplace** (e.g., parents, relatives, older friends, colleagues—people with real work experience). Do not interview students.
    - **Important:** All groups must use the **same set of interview questions** (or at least the same guiding points / themes) so that results are comparable across the cohort.

Coordinate with other groups during the Research & Testing Check-in to agree on questions or guiding points before drafting your plan.
   - **Get your interview questions reviewed** before you run any interviews.
   - Create `/docs/research-plan.md` in GitHub and log: who you will interview, when, and which questions you'll use.

3. **Run and capture interviews**

   - Each interviewer speaks to at least 2 people (aim for 5–8 participants per group total).
   - Capture notes in a shared document or as sticky notes on a Figma board.
   - Save raw notes in a `/research` folder in your GitHub repo.

4. **Synthesise and define hypotheses**

   - Cluster pain points into themes (e.g., "cannot find info", "too many tools", "don't trust AI suggestions").
   - Write **3–5 hypotheses** in the format:
     - *We believe that [solution] will help Christoph [benefit] because [reason]*.
   - Store them in `/docs/hypotheses.md` and also on a Figma frame.

5. **Draft success metrics**

   - Define how you will measure whether your solution works (e.g., task completion rate, time to find info, user confidence rating).
   - Store in `/docs/success-metrics.md`.

6. **Create the Current vs Future journey map**

   - In Figma, draw a **Current journey** lane (today's experience) and a **Future journey** lane (with HiveMind) for your focus area.
   - Highlight the key moments you will design (e.g., "Day 1 dashboard", "First AI question", "Finding key documents").

7. **Update your evidence pack**

   - Export the journey map and add it to your **Design** or **Research** folder.
   - Update your weekly log with: what you did, who did it, and roughly how long it took.

Week 2: Information Architecture & Wireframing

1. **Turn insights into information architecture**

   - List the main chunks of information Christoph needs in your area (e.g., "My tasks", "Team knowledge", "Contacts", "AI help").

- UX/IA Designer creates a simple **IA diagram / sitemap** in Figma showing pages, sections, and nav labels.

2. **Define 2–3 critical user tasks**
   - Choose the key tasks you will design and later test, for example:
     - "Find who to contact about a specific question."
     - "See my onboarding progress and what's next."
     - "Ask the AI for guidance and understand why it replied that way."
   - Write these as clear task statements in `/testing/tasks.md`.

3. **Sketch low-fidelity wireframes in Figma**
   - On the **Wireframes** page, create quick grey-box wireframes for each task flow (no colours or detailed visuals).
   - Focus on: what appears on each screen, what Christoph clicks, and how he moves from one step to the next.

4. **Reference Carbon patterns while wireframing**
   - Open the **Carbon React Storybook** and use it as a reference for layouts and basic components (buttons, inputs, modals).
   - In Figma, use shapes that roughly match Carbon components so it's easier to align visuals in Week 3.

5. **Review with mentors and trim scope**
   - In your mentor session, walk through your IA and wireframes.
   - Agree which flows and screens will be **in scope** for the high-fi prototype.
   - Record any scope changes in `/docs/decisions.md`.

6. **Update evidence**
   - Export IA diagrams and key wireframes (PNG or PDF) to the **Design** folder.
   - Update the weekly log with activities and time spent.

Week 3: High-Fidelity UI & Trust Patterns

Core for everyone: high-fi Figma prototype

1. **Define a mini Carbon-style system in Figma**
   - UI Designer creates styles for typography, colours, and basic components that align with **Carbon** examples (e.g., primary button style, text input style).
   - Document these in a small "Design tokens" frame or library within the Figma file.

2. **Convert wireframes to high-fi screens**
   - On the **UI** page, redraw your key wireframes as high-fidelity screens using your Figma styles.
   - Make sure navigation, labels, and content match your IA and task flows from Week 2.
3. **Build an interactive Figma prototype**
   - On the **Prototype** page, link screens to create **end-to-end flows** for each critical task.
   - Include hover states, error states, and confirmation states where relevant.
4. **Design for trust and clarity (especially AI)**
   - For any AI or recommendation elements, add microcopy that explains:
     - why this is suggested,
     - where the information came from,
     - what the user can do next.
   - Make sure users can always see how to undo actions or change inputs.
   - **AI Assistant groups:** define conversation states, "why this answer" explanations, and error/fallback behaviour.
5. **Internal dry run**
   - One teammate "plays" Christoph and uses the prototype while others observe.
   - Note any confusion or dead ends and quickly fix them in Figma.

Optional stretch: small React + Carbon + Storybook slice

6. **Set up a minimal React + Carbon app**
   - In your GitHub repo, create a basic React app (CRA, Vite, or similar).
   - Install `@carbon/react` and configure Sass so you can import Carbon styles.
   - Add a short setup section to `/tech/README.md`.
7. **Implement 1–2 key UI slices using Carbon**
   - Pick a small part of your design (e.g., a dashboard card, an AI input form).
   - Implement it in React using Carbon components (e.g., `Button`, `TextInput`, `Tile`).
   - Keep the logic simple and focused on showing the UI.
8. **Add Storybook and stories (if time)**
   - Initialise Storybook for React in your project.
   - Write stories that show your Carbon components in different states (default, hover, error, empty).

- (Optional) Install `@carbon/storybook-addon-theme` to preview components in different Carbon themes.

9. **Document how to run the demo**

   - In `/tech/README.md`, clearly explain how to:
     - install dependencies,
     - run the React app,
     - run Storybook.

Week 4: Validation & Findings

1. **Plan your usability tests**

   - UX Research Lead writes a short **test script** including:
     - intro and consent,
     - 3–4 tasks based on your defined flows,
     - a few closing questions (e.g., "How confident do you feel now?").
   - Decide whether you'll show only the Figma prototype or also any Storybook/React components.

2. **Recruit 3–5 participants**

   - Target **professionals with workplace experience** who match your target audience (not students).
   - Book short 20–30 minute sessions and add them to your weekly log.

3. **Run the sessions and capture data**

   - Ask participants to think aloud while completing each task in the prototype.
   - For each task, note: success/failure, time taken, major issues, and a simple rating (e.g., 1–5 for ease).
   - Save notes in your `/testing` folder.

4. **Synthesise results and define recommendations**

   - Group findings into themes (e.g., navigation issues, unclear wording, AI mistrust, missing feedback).
   - For each theme, write: what happened, why it matters, and what you recommend changing.
   - Draft a concise **validation report** (`/delivery/validation-report.md`).

5. **Prepare the final presentation**

   - Create a 10-minute deck covering:

        - problem & Christoph,
        - your concept,
        - key prototype screens,
        - what you tested,
        - results & recommendations.
    - Include links to your Figma prototype and, if relevant, a short live demo of your React/Storybook slice.

6. **Finalise the evidence pack**

    - Check that your folders are complete: `README`, weekly logs, research, design, testing, delivery, and (if relevant) tech.
    - Make sure filenames are clear and someone external could follow your process from start to finish.